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Bay Area Prepares For June 2 National Day of Protest

ANTI-WEBER FORCES WIN FUNDS FROM OAKLAND CITY COUNCIL

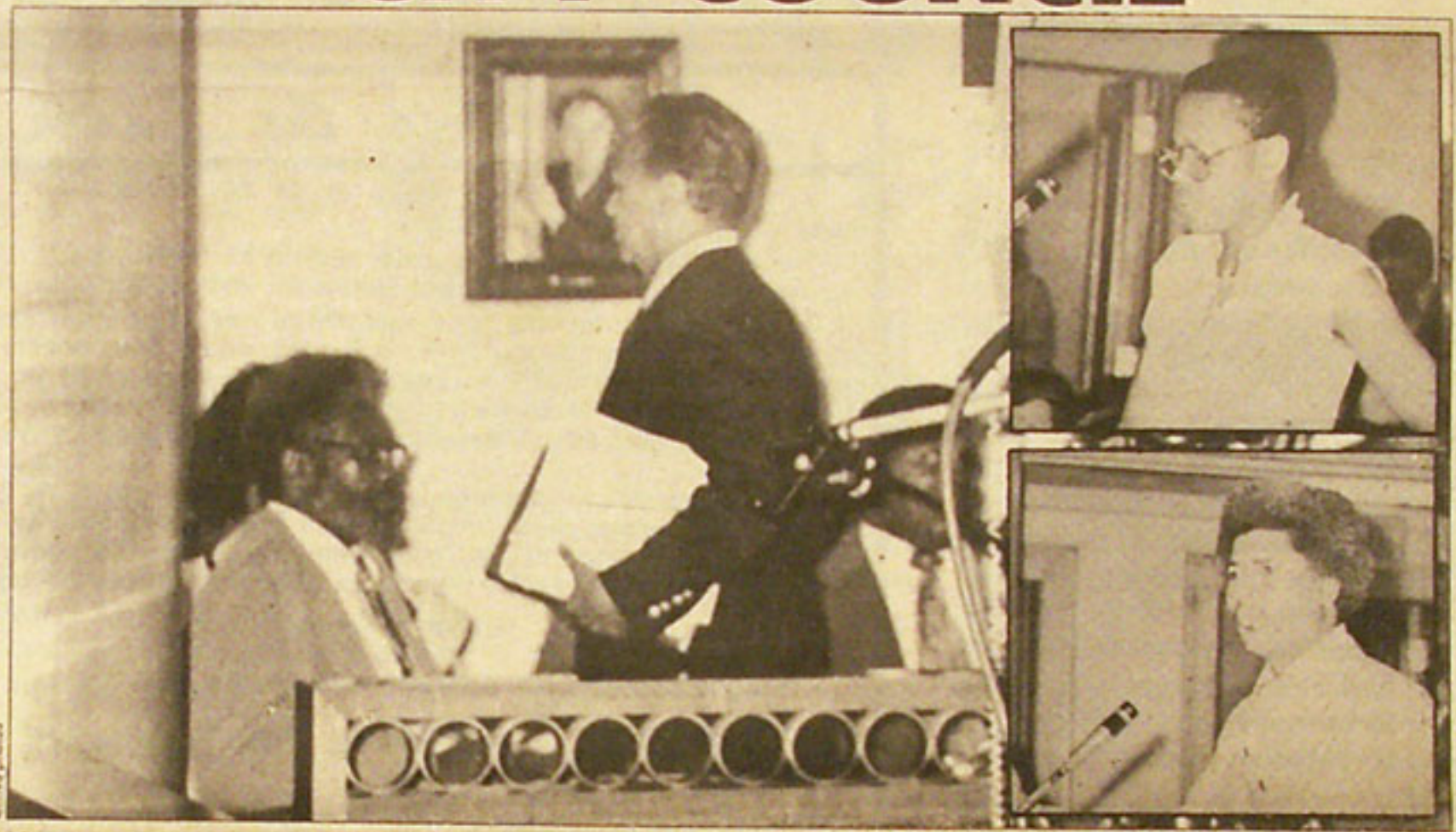
(Oakland, Calif.) - Strong pressure from a coalition of Black and poor community organizations here in late May succeeded in forcing the Oakland City Council to provide \$5,000 in funds and materials for the Bay Area's upcoming June 2 National Day of Protest against the Weber Decision.

If upheld by the U.S. Supreme Court, the Weber case will outlaw voluntary affirmative action employment programs and put millions of Black and poor people out of work.

The Northern California Coalition to Overturn the Weber Case (NCCOWC), organized and led by Lorenza Carlisle, went before the city council and demanded the following: (1) That June 2 be declared National Day of Protest against the Weber Decision in Oakland; (2) That the NCCOWC be allowed to hang anti-Weber banners on four street corners in the city; and (3) That \$5,000 be appropriated to the Coalition for expenses for the June 2 protest.

Mayor Lionel Wilson, who arrived late for the council meeting, which was chaired by Vice Mayor John Sutter, visibly angered the community people present when he abruptly left council chambers during speeches made by NCCOWC members.

The Black mayor, who has recently been under severe attack from Black and poor people—who put him in office in 1977—for failing to deal with Oakland's skyrocketing unemployment rate, looked bored throughout the Weber discussion, openly yawning several



Oakland Mayor LIONEL WILSON (above) leaves city council meeting during presentation by anti-Weber forces demanding city funds for the June 2 national anti-Weber protest. BLACK PANTHER editor JONINA ABRON (top, right) and LORENZA CARLISLE, anti-Weber coalition organizer, address city council.

times.

Sutter explained the mayor's departure when one of the Coalition speakers asked why he had left. According to the vice mayor, Wilson had to catch a plane for Washington, D.C., where he was going on "official city business."

In January of this year, a delegation of community groups organized by Lorenza Carlisle, who is chairperson of the Caterpillar Anti-Discrimination Committee, went before the city council to demand that Oakland take an official stand against the Weber case. As a

JUDGE DENIES MOTION TO DISMISS HUEY P. NEWTON CASE

(Oakland, Calif.) - A defense motion to stop the retrial of Black Panther Party President Huey P. Newton on a false murder charge was denied here in mid-May in Alameda County Superior Court.

Attorney Thomas Steel, appearing on behalf of Huey, argued that Superior Court Judge Carl West Anderson, who presided in Huey's first trial earlier this year on charges that he killed Black prostitute Kathleen Smith in 1974, failed to inquire into blatant jury tampering discovered on the last day of the trial, March 24.

On that day, it was learned that on the first day of jury deliberations, an alternate juror named

Mrs. Menees had handed a note to one of the main jurors, Mrs. Silva, urging Silva to "Go hang him (Huey)." Anderson claimed that the incident had no serious effect on jury deliberations and refused to dismiss Silva or Menees.

Silva was one of two jurors who held out for a guilty verdict in the trial. Anderson declared a mistrial after the jury reported it was hopelessly deadlocked 10-2 for Huey's acquittal.

After listening to arguments by Deputy District Attorney Thomas Orloff, who claimed that there was no evidence of jury tampering, Judge Martin Pulich, a

BLACK YOUTH SENTENCED TO 25 YEARS IN PRISON

(Prince George's County, Md.) - The Black and poor community held an angry demonstration here recently to protest the outrageous 25-year prison term given to a 16-year-old Black youth falsely convicted for killing two White policemen who beat him up.

Terrence Johnson was convicted in April of voluntary manslaughter in the June 28, 1978, shooting deaths of Prince George's County police officers Albert Claggett and James Brian Swart.

The manslaughter conviction and the illegal use of a pistol were charges resulting from the shooting of Claggett. The Black youth was acquitted by reason of temporary insanity on all charges related to Swart's death.

Defense attorneys charged that young Johnson was severely beaten by Claggett and had shot the police officer in self-defense. Johnson, his lawyers said, then lost control of himself and killed Swart.

Johnson faces a maximum sentence of 10 years in prison on the manslaughter charge and 15 years on the handgun charge.

The 1978 incident occurred when Terrence and his brother Melvin were stopped by police on their way to the movies. The two Black youth were arrested because their car registration tags were allegedly invalid.

At the police station, Terrence Johnson was handcuffed to a

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